Tabletop Exercise After-Action Report: TT-20261113-79E1

Core provider ransomware on a Friday evening

EXERCISE ONLY. This is a tabletop drill, not a real incident. Nothing here is reported to the NCUA. This report is a training aid, not legal advice. The answer keys apply 12 CFR 748.1(c) and NCUA Letter 23-CU-07 to fictional facts; a facilitator may reasonably disagree with a call. Verify real determinations against the current rule and NCUA guidance, and consult counsel where needed.

Score	92 of 100: Strong
Scenario	Core provider ransomware on a Friday evening (core-ransomware)
Credit union	Example Federal Credit Union (fictional)
Facilitator	Pat Example
Participants	CEO, CISO, COO, Compliance Officer, Marketing
Exercise run	Fri Nov 13, 2026 11:48 AM PST
Simulated start	Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST
Simulated clock	frozen between injects
Status	complete

1. Score

Area	Points	Out of	Detail
Reportability call	40	40	Team: REPORTABLE. Answer key: REPORTABLE.
Test-by-test answers	17	20	5 of 6 match the answer key.
NCUA notice within 72 hours	25	30	Notified 18h 00m after the clock started, 2d 6h 00m before the deadline.
Reasonable belief recorded promptly	10	10	Recorded Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST, in step with the facts.

2. Findings

• Strength: the team reached the right call, REPORTABLE.

• Gap: one test answer differs from the answer key. The table below shows why.

• Gap: the notice was on time, but the rule says as soon as possible, and it took most of a day. Ask what held it up.

3. Reportability call

Team: REPORTABLE. Answer key: REPORTABLE.

Test	Team	Team's reasoning	Key	Why
Is it a cyber incident?	Yes	Ransomware at the core provider.	Yes	Ransomware encrypted the systems running the credit union's core. Availability, and possibly confidentiality, were actually jeopardized without lawful authority.
Is it excluded as authorized, good-faith activity?	No	Not authorized.	No	Nobody requested or authorized this activity.
Is the cyber incident substantial?	Yes	Core and cards down.	Yes	Appendix A lists ransomware attacks impacting critical systems or data. Core and member channels went down.

Test	Team	Team's reasoning	Key	Why
Prong A: substantial loss of confidentiality, integrity or availability	Yes	Member services disrupted.	Yes	Vital member services (online banking, cards) were disrupted, a substantial loss of availability.
Prong B: disruption from a cyberattack or exploited vulnerability	Unsure (differs)	Not sure an outage at the provider counts as our disruption.	Yes	Business operations and member systems were disrupted by a cyberattack.
Prong C: third-party or supply chain compromise	Yes	Through the core provider.	Yes	The disruption was caused by a compromise of a third-party data hosting provider.

4. The 72-hour clock

For a third-party incident, the 72 hours run from the provider's notice or the credit union's own reasonable belief, whichever is sooner. Here that is the provider's Friday evening call, not the later confirmation and not Monday morning.

Clock should have started	Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST (third-party notice)
Deadline	Mon Nov 16, 2026 4:45 PM PST
Team's clock	NCUA notified Sat Nov 14, 2026 10:45 AM PST, 2d 6h 00m before the Mon Nov 16, 2026 4:45 PM PST deadline.
Team's reasonable belief	Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST
NCUA notified (simulated)	Sat Nov 14, 2026 10:45 AM PST

5. Debrief questions

• Who on the team is authorized to call 1-833-CYBERCU after hours, and is that written down?

• When did the 72-hour clock start, and did everyone in the room agree?

• What does your cyber insurance policy require, and by when? Insurer notice windows are often shorter than 72 hours.

• If member data turns out to be in the leak, who decides on member notice under Part 748 Appendix B and any state breach laws?

• Does the core provider's contract require it to notify you promptly, and did it?

6. Exercise timeline

#	Simulated time	Entry
1	Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST	Exercise started: Core provider ransomware on a Friday evening.
2	Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST	Inject 1: Call from your core provider. The incident manager at Example Core Services, Inc. calls your on-call line. They are investigating a security event in their hosting environment and have taken several client instances offline as a precaution, including yours. Next update in about two hours.
3	Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST	Notice from third party Example Core Services, Inc. received Fri Nov 13, 2026 4:45 PM PST. Call from your core provider
4	Fri Nov 13, 2026 5:05 PM PST	Inject 2: Members can't get in. The contact center reports a spike in calls. Online banking and the mobile app show 'temporarily unavailable.' Card authorizations are falling back to stand-in limits.
5	Fri Nov 13, 2026 6:45 PM PST	Inject 3: Provider confirms ransomware. The provider confirms ransomware in its hosting environment. Servers running your instance were encrypted. They are still investigating whether data was taken. Restoring from offline backups will take 24 to 48 hours.
6	Fri Nov 13, 2026 6:45 PM PST	Note (as of Fri Nov 13, 2026 6:45 PM PST): Waiting for the provider's next update before deciding.
7	Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST	Inject 4: Pressure from the corner office. Your CEO asks whether anyone has to be told tonight or whether it can wait until Monday. Your cyber insurer's hotline asks for the policy number and whether any regulator has been notified.
8	Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST	Reasonable belief recorded as of Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST. Basis: CEO asked; provider confirmation at 6:45 PM was enough.
9	Fri Nov 13, 2026 7:45 PM PST	Team assessed reportability: REPORTABLE. A substantial cyber incident that meets Prongs A and C.
10	Sat Nov 14, 2026 10:45 AM PST	Inject 5: Saturday morning. The provider restores core in read-only mode. Branches open with manual procedures and withdrawal limits. Online banking is still down.
11	Sat Nov 14, 2026 10:45 AM PST	Team notified the NCUA (simulated) by phone. SIMULATED, exercise only. Voicemail at 1-833-CYBERCU with name, charter, contact and description.
12	Sun Nov 15, 2026 4:45 PM PST	Inject 6: Leak site claim. A ransomware group posts a claim naming the provider on its leak site. It is not yet clear whether your members' data was included.
13	Mon Nov 16, 2026 5:45 PM PST	Inject 7: Monday afternoon: your examiner calls. Your NCUA examiner calls and asks when the credit union notified the agency, and how the credit union decided the incident was reportable.
14	Mon Nov 16, 2026 5:45 PM PST	Exercise ended. Score 92 of 100.

7. Log integrity

Verified: 14 entries, hash chain intact. Final SHA-256: 99e874fe802e3cd64975e965f6e85d52fcff31f7c1f2bc4cf4345fdecfe1d312

8. Sources

• 12 CFR 748.1(c), Cyber incident notification requirements: https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-12/chapter-VII/subchapter-A/part-748

• NCUA Letter to Credit Unions 23-CU-07, Cyber Incident Notification Requirements (Aug. 2023): https://ncua.gov/regulation-supervision/letters-credit-unions-other-guidance/cyber-incident-notification-requirements

• 23-CU-07 Appendix A, examples that likely would qualify: https://ncua.gov/regulation-supervision/letters-credit-unions-other-guidance/cyber-incident-notification-requirements/appendix-a

• 23-CU-07 Appendix B, examples that likely would not qualify: https://ncua.gov/regulation-supervision/letters-credit-unions-other-guidance/cyber-incident-notification-requirements/appendix-b